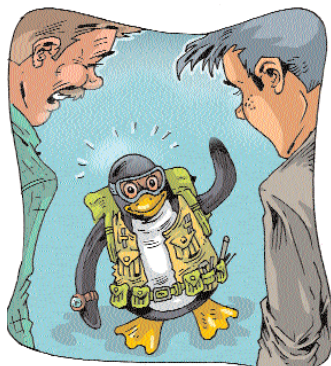


LINUX



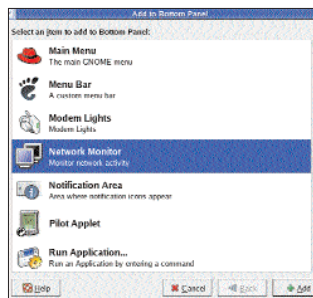
Keeping Track Of Network Traffic

Linux, by default, does not show a network traffic icon in the panel. The icon shows if your computer is connected to the network or has a broken link.

Gnome users need not worry. The tool is there—all you need to know is where to find it. KDE users, don't waste time looking for the tool! And obviously, those who prefer to work in text mode do not have such privileges.

For Gnome users: to add the Network Activity Monitor to the panel, right-click on the bottom panel and choose 'Add to Panel...' This will open the "Add to Bottom Panel" dialog box. Scroll down the list to choose Network Monitor and then click Add. The Network Monitor is by default configured to eth0, so double-click on it and configure your Ethernet card accordingly.

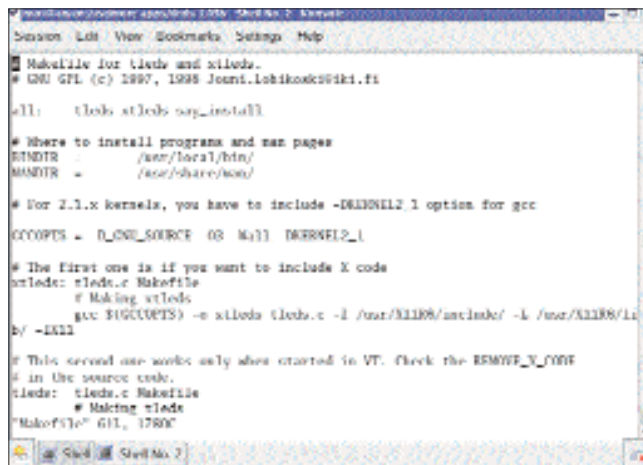
KDE and text mode users need not be disheartened by the absence of this facility. You can make use of the LEDs on the keyboard. The Scroll Lock LED is never used, and



Network Monitor will add an interactive icon on the bottom panel in Gnome desktop

the Num Lock is turned off by default in Linux. You can make use of these two LEDs to show network activity. Download the Tleds package from <http://users.tkk.fi/~jlohikos/tleds.html>

You can run this software on any interface, such as ppp0 or eth0. You need to know which interface of the machine is connected and active to the network. Let's assume eth0 is connected to the Internet, and it is also active offline



Make the changes to the following lines in the Makefile under tleds folder just before compiling it

Download version 1.05beta10, available in tar.gz format. Any Linux x86 machine user can download and use this software. You may have to make a few changes or get certain dependencies resolved, because the package may not cater to all distributions. The newer beta version has support for kernel 2.1.x, 2.2 and also 2.4. So, after you have downloaded the tarball and extracted it to a suitable folder, open the Makefile in a text editor and make the following changes:

Append the line 'GCCOPTS = -D_GNU_SOURCE -O3 -Wall' with an entry '-DKERNEL2_1' to support lower version of kernel. The final line will be 'GCCOPTS = -D_GNU_SOURCE -O3 -Wall -DKERNEL2_1'

The last change is for the man files entries. Tleds adds man pages to /usr/local/man; we need to change this to /usr/share/man. Look for the line 'MANDIR = /usr/local/man/' and make the necessary changes.

After you are done with the changes, install the package by issuing the following command:

#make all install + [Enter]

but on a LAN. To activate tleds on eth0 issue:

#tleds -qd 50 eth0 [Enter]

The Num Lock LED shows received packets, while the Scroll Lock LED shows sent packets.

In order to activate tleds for eth0 on every boot, do the following:

#echo

"/usr/local/bin/tleds -qcd 50 eth0" >>/etc/rc.d/rc.local

If you want to run tleds again but on a different interface, then issue 'tleds -k' and re-run the tleds command on the interface you want it to run on. For ppp0 users, the command switch will vary slightly: 'tleds -qd 100 ppp0'.

MP3 In Text Mode, MP3 Blaster

The heart of the Linux or Unix platforms lies in the text mode of the OS, popularly known as the command line. Many enthusiastic open source developers have helped to bring entertainment even to the command line atmosphere, which is perhaps unimaginable for a Windows user.

MP3Blaster is one such non-graphical music player for Unix-like operating

systems. The development of this utility is still alive as a project at sourceforge.net. To download MP3Blaster, go to

http://sourceforge.net/project/stats?group_id=154673&u=mp3blaster

The file you get here is a tarball (tar.gz or tar.bz2). We follow a method by which we download such applications to a folder called "Utilities", and if it is a tarball file, we extract it to another folder called "more-apps". This way, we can avoid folders and files of the same name (extraction creates a folder with a name identical to the compressed file) under the same folder, and this is also a methodical approach. So the command we use to extract is:

[root@test3 Utilities]# tar -C /usr/more-apps/ -zxvf mp3blaster-3.1.3.tar.gz

Now change your directory to /usr/more-apps/mp3blaster-3.1.3 to start with the installation. To install:

./configure + [Enter]

This command collects the system details and creates a file containing these details. The process may take some time, and if dependencies are encountered, you need to clear those by downloading the necessary packages.

#make + [Enter]

Uses the system information recorded by the configure script to build an application as per your system. This process may consume time depending on your system performance.

#make install + [Enter]

This process places all the build files of an application in folders as per the Linux File System Standard.

At the shell prompt, type in "mp3b" and hit [Tab]. This should complete the command as "mp3blaster". If it doesn't, then hit [Tab] twice to list all probable commands that begin with "mp3b". This is a shortcut to know if your application has been installed perfectly, and of course, even run it.

#mp3blaster + [Enter]

Will start the application on the entire Konsole window. That means you will have to dedicate a mingetty (TTY) to MP3Blaster.